

Manwei Liu

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ACADEMIC POSITION

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Nanjing Audit University, 2021–present.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Tilburg University, 2021.

M.A. in Economics, Renmin University of China, 2014.

B.A. in Economics, Renmin University of China, 2012.

RESEARCH FIELDS

Behavioral economics, Experimental economics.

PUBLICATIONS

“Counteracting Narratives: Evidence from an Online Experiment”, with Sili Zhang. *the Economic Journal*, 136.673 (2026): 125-162.

WORKING PAPERS

“Majority voting or dictatorship? How collective-choice rules affect institutional design and cooperation”, with Eline van der Heijden. Collective-choice rules aggregate individual choices into a collective choice. This experimental study addresses the role of collective-choice rules in self-governance via institutional design in a social dilemma. Groups decide repeatedly on whether to establish any institution, and if so which institutions, to sustain cooperation in a public goods game. We hypothesize that collective-choice rules may directly affect cooperation, conditional on having the same institutions. They may also have an indirect effect on cooperation, via institutional choices. We implement three collective-choice rules: majority voting, dictatorship and rotating dictatorship. Our main findings are: (1) cooperation level is not higher under the institutions chosen via a democratic rule than when the same institutions are chosen via a non-democratic rule. (2) Institutional choices made via majority voting or a fixed dictator are more stable over time than those chosen by rotating dictators. (3) The instability of institutions is associated with lower cooperation level. These results have implications for the organization of small-scale group-decision.

Presented at: 3rd Workshop in Political Economy and Public Economics, Max Plank Institute for Tax Law and Public Finance; 12th Maastricht Behavioral and Experimental Economics Symposium, Maastricht University; TIBER Symposium 2019, Tilburg University; Microlab Seminar, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona; 13th Nordic Conference on Behavioral and Experimental Economics, University of Southern Denmark; 9th Thurgau Experimental Economics Meeting, Thurgau Institute; The 5th Annual International Workshop on Economic Analysis of Institutions, Xiamen University; internal seminar, Tilburg University.

“The relativity of moral judgments” Moral judgments are important factors in individual decision-making and interpersonal interactions. I examine the relativity of moral judgments, specifically, whether moral judgments toward a decision maker depend on the reference decision maker’s choice. The results of an experiment show that people punish a decision maker who chooses an immoral action more harshly when they observe another moral choice

than if they observe another immoral one. A contrast effect, rather than a shift in perceived social norms, accounts for the relativity. The relativity of moral judgments suggests that there exists non-monetary spillover effects of one's action on another. The results have implications for moral behavior in markets and in other social contexts. Presented at: 2019 European ESA Meeting, Burgundy School of Business; TIBER Symposium 2018, Tilburg University; 2018 ESA World Meeting, Humboldt-University Berlin.

“Auction Design with Aftermarket: How Auction Format Limits Signaling”, with Yanlin Chen. We study the optimal information design in auctions where the winner subsequently interacts with a third-party incumbent in an aftermarket. Our theory predicts that disclosing the winner's type creates a signaling incentive: bidders compete more aggressively to signal high economic efficiency to the incumbent, thereby increasing seller revenue. We test these predictions in a laboratory setting, varying the auction format (first-price or second-price) and the disclosure rule (full or none). While disclosure significantly increases revenue in FP auctions as predicted, the effect vanishes in SP auctions. This is driven by widespread and persistent overbidding in SP auctions, which pushes revenue above FP levels regardless of disclosure policy. We find that overbidding is more prevalent among bidders with higher economic efficiency and risk-seeking subjects, and exhibits a contagion effect: exposure to an overbidding opponent triggers spiteful or imitative overbidding in subsequent rounds. Our results suggest that the effect of information disclosure is sensitive to the auction format and behavioral anomalies can break the signaling mechanism in second-price auctions.

Presented at: 2026 European ESA Meeting, Pompeu Fabra University.

“When to feed the Leviathan: Trading-off between efficiency, fairness, and the intrinsic value of power”, with Yadi Yang.

Presented at: 2024 Asian-Pacific ESA Meeting, Osaka University; 2024 ESA World Meeting, Renmin University.

“Subjective facts and objective opinions”, with Sili Zhang

“Mistakes or misbeliefs? Decomposing strategic naivety about undisclosed information”, with Tingting Wu.

PUBLICATIONS (IN CHINESE)

Zhou, Y., He, H., Huang, G., Liu, M. (2014). “A leader leads by example? An Experimental Study of the Public Goods Game”. *Management World*, (10), 75–90.

Zhou, Y., He, H., Huang, G., Liu, M. (2015). “Group Leader and Individual Leader: An Experimental Study of Public Goods Game”. *Finance & Trade Economics*, (5), 20–34.

TEACHING

- Behavioral Economics (undergraduate).
- Behavioral Economics (graduate).
- Games and markets (undergraduate).

FUNDS

- National Nature Science Fund, 2025